

ENG-113: ENGLISH FOR ALL — ORAL COMMUNICATION

BCA Examination Notes

Complete Exam Preparation | All Units Covered | 20 Most Important Questions Included

UNIT 1: INTRODUCTION TO COMMUNICATION

1.1 What is Communication?

Communication is the process of exchanging information, ideas, feelings, or thoughts between a sender and a receiver through a common system of signs, symbols, or behaviour.

Definition (2 marks): Communication is the process of transmitting and receiving messages through a medium between two or more persons to achieve mutual understanding.

1.2 Elements of Communication

- **Sender:** The person who initiates the message.
- **Message:** The information, idea, or feeling to be conveyed.
- **Encoding:** Converting the idea into words, symbols, or gestures.
- **Channel/Medium:** The path through which the message travels (e.g., voice, phone, email).
- **Receiver:** The person who receives the message.
- **Decoding:** Interpreting the message by the receiver.
- **Feedback:** The response or reaction of the receiver to the message.
- **Noise/Barrier:** Any interference that distorts the message.

1.3 Types of Communication

- **Verbal Communication:** Using spoken or written words.
- **Non-verbal Communication:** Body language, gestures, facial expressions, posture.
- **Oral Communication:** Face-to-face talks, phone calls, presentations, interviews.
- **Written Communication:** Letters, emails, reports, memos.

1.4 Importance of Communication

- Helps express ideas and feelings clearly.
- Essential for professional and personal success.
- Builds relationships and trust.
- Enables decision-making and problem-solving.
- Promotes teamwork and cooperation.

UNIT 2: ORAL COMMUNICATION SKILLS

2.1 What is Oral Communication?

Oral communication refers to any form of communication that involves spoken words. It includes conversations, speeches, interviews, group discussions, presentations, and telephonic communication.

2.2 Features of Effective Oral Communication

- **Clarity:** Use simple, clear, and direct language.
- **Brevity:** Be short and to the point.
- **Accuracy:** Use correct information and facts.
- **Confidence:** Speak with conviction and assurance.
- **Good Pronunciation:** Pronounce words correctly.
- **Appropriate Pace:** Neither too fast nor too slow.
- **Eye Contact:** Maintain eye contact with the audience.
- **Active Listening:** Listen carefully and respond appropriately.

2.3 Active Listening

Active listening is the process of fully concentrating, understanding, and responding to a speaker. It involves both hearing the words and understanding the meaning.

- Pay full attention to the speaker.
- Do not interrupt while the speaker is talking.
- Ask relevant questions at appropriate time.
- Provide non-verbal cues like nodding.
- Summarise what you heard to confirm understanding.

2.4 Barriers to Oral Communication

- **Physical Barriers:** Noise, distance, poor acoustics.
- **Psychological Barriers:** Fear, stress, lack of confidence.
- **Language Barriers:** Use of jargon, difficult vocabulary.
- **Cultural Barriers:** Differences in customs and values.
- **Perceptual Barriers:** Different understanding of the same message.

UNIT 3: TYPES OF ORAL COMMUNICATION

3.1 Formal Oral Communication

Formal oral communication follows a structured format and is used in professional or official settings.

- Board meetings and conferences.
- Speeches and presentations.
- Job interviews.
- Academic seminars.

3.2 Informal Oral Communication

Informal oral communication is casual and unstructured. It takes place in everyday situations without following any rules.

- Conversations between friends.
- Casual discussions in a group.
- Gossip and chit-chat.

3.3 Interview Skills

An interview is a formal oral communication where a candidate is assessed for a job, admission, or other purpose.

Tips for a Successful Interview:

- Research about the organisation before the interview.
- Dress appropriately and reach on time.

- Greet the interviewer with a smile and handshake.
- Listen carefully to each question before answering.
- Speak clearly, confidently, and concisely.
- Avoid negative body language (slouching, looking away).
- End the interview by thanking the interviewer.

3.4 Group Discussion (GD)

A group discussion is an activity where a group of people discuss a given topic. It is used to assess communication, teamwork, and leadership skills.

Do's in a Group Discussion:

- Initiate the discussion confidently.
- Listen to others before responding.
- Support your views with facts and examples.
- Be polite and respectful to other participants.

Don'ts in a Group Discussion:

- Do not monopolise the discussion.
- Do not interrupt or argue aggressively.
- Do not go off-topic.
- Do not remain silent throughout.

3.5 Public Speaking and Presentation

Public speaking is addressing an audience to inform, persuade, or entertain. Good presentations require preparation, clear structure, and confident delivery.

Structure of a Presentation:

1. **Introduction:** Greet the audience, introduce yourself, state the topic.
2. **Body:** Present main points with examples and evidence.
3. **Conclusion:** Summarise key points, thank the audience, invite questions.

UNIT 4: NON-VERBAL COMMUNICATION

4.1 What is Non-Verbal Communication?

Non-verbal communication refers to conveying messages without using spoken or written words. It includes body language, facial expressions, gestures, eye contact, and appearance.

4.2 Types of Non-Verbal Communication

- **Kinesics:** Study of body movements, gestures, and posture.
- **Proxemics:** Use of space and distance in communication.
- **Chronemics:** Use of time in communication (punctuality, etc.).
- **Paralanguage:** Tone, pitch, volume, and pace of voice.
- **Haptics:** Communication through touch (handshake, pat on back).

4.3 Importance of Non-Verbal Communication

- Reinforces verbal messages.
- Expresses emotions without words.

- Helps build rapport and trust.
- Regulates conversational flow.

UNIT 5: TELEPHONE AND MODERN ORAL COMMUNICATION

5.1 Telephone Etiquette

- Answer calls promptly and politely.
- Introduce yourself at the beginning of the call.
- Speak clearly and at a moderate pace.
- Take notes if necessary.
- End the conversation politely with a thank you.

5.2 Video Conferencing and Virtual Communication

Modern oral communication includes virtual meetings via platforms like Zoom, Google Meet, and Microsoft Teams.

Best Practices:

- Test your audio and video before the meeting.
- Dress professionally even for virtual meetings.
- Mute yourself when not speaking.
- Maintain eye contact with the camera.

20 MOST IMPORTANT QUESTIONS WITH ANSWERS — ENG-113

Q1. Define communication and explain its elements.

[6 marks]

Ans. Communication is the process of exchanging information, ideas, feelings, or thoughts between a sender and a receiver through a medium to achieve mutual understanding.

Elements of Communication:

1. **Sender:** The person who originates and sends the message.
2. **Message:** The content or information to be conveyed.
3. **Encoding:** The process of converting the message into a suitable form (words, symbols).
4. **Channel:** The medium through which the message is transmitted (voice, email, telephone).
5. **Receiver:** The person who receives and understands the message.
6. **Decoding:** Interpreting and understanding the message by the receiver.
7. **Feedback:** The response given by the receiver back to the sender.
8. **Noise/Barrier:** Any interference that distorts or blocks the message.

Effective communication occurs when all these elements function properly and the message is correctly understood.

Q2. What is oral communication? Explain its types.

[6 marks]

Ans. Oral communication refers to any communication that involves the use of spoken words. It is the most natural and direct form of communication.

Types of Oral Communication:

1. **Interpersonal Communication:** One-on-one conversation between two people.
2. **Group Communication:** Communication within a small or large group, e.g., meetings, GD.
3. **Public Communication:** Addressing a large audience, e.g., speeches, lectures.
4. **Mass Communication:** Communication to a vast audience through media like radio, TV.
5. **Formal Oral Communication:** Structured and official, e.g., interviews, presentations.
6. **Informal Oral Communication:** Casual and unstructured, e.g., friendly conversations.

Q3. Write short notes on Active Listening.

[4 marks]

Ans. Active listening is the skill of fully concentrating, understanding, and responding to a speaker. It goes beyond merely hearing words — it involves understanding the complete message.

Features of Active Listening:

- Give undivided attention to the speaker.
- Show interest through body language (nod, eye contact).
- Do not interrupt the speaker.
- Ask clarifying questions after the speaker finishes.
- Paraphrase or summarise to confirm understanding.

Active listening reduces misunderstandings and improves the quality of communication.

Q4. What are the barriers to oral communication?

[6 marks]

Ans. Barriers to oral communication are obstacles that prevent effective exchange of information.

Types of Barriers:

1. **Physical Barriers:** Noise, poor acoustics, distance, or technical problems.
2. **Psychological Barriers:** Fear of speaking, stress, lack of confidence, or emotional state.
3. **Language Barriers:** Use of difficult vocabulary, jargon, dialects, or poor pronunciation.

4. **Cultural Barriers:** Differences in values, customs, gestures that lead to misunderstanding.

5. **Attitudinal Barriers:** Ego, prejudice, or pre-conceived notions about the speaker.

6. **Perceptual Barriers:** Different individuals interpret the same message differently.

To overcome these barriers, speakers should use clear language, listen patiently, and be sensitive to the audience.

Q5. Define non-verbal communication and explain its types.

[4 marks]

Ans. Non-verbal communication is the transmission of messages without the use of spoken or written words. It uses body movements, gestures, facial expressions, and space.

Types:

- **Kinesics:** Body language — gestures, posture, facial expressions.
- **Proxemics:** Use of personal space and distance.
- **Paralanguage:** Tone, volume, pitch, and rate of speech.
- **Haptics:** Communication through touch (handshake, pat).
- **Chronemics:** Communication through use of time (punctuality).

Q6. What is a Group Discussion? What are its do's and don'ts?

[6 marks]

Ans. A Group Discussion (GD) is a structured activity where a group of participants discuss a given topic. It tests communication, analytical, and interpersonal skills.

Do's in a GD:

- Initiate or enter the discussion confidently.
- Support your points with relevant facts and examples.
- Listen to other participants respectfully.
- Maintain eye contact and use appropriate body language.

Don'ts in a GD:

- Do not dominate the discussion or interrupt others.
- Do not go off-topic or repeat the same point.
- Do not remain completely silent or passive.
- Do not use aggressive or impolite language.

Q7. What is feedback in communication? Why is it important?

[4 marks]

Ans. Feedback is the response or reaction given by the receiver to the sender after receiving the message. It completes the communication cycle.

Importance of Feedback:

- It confirms whether the message was received and understood correctly.
- It helps the sender improve future messages.
- It makes communication two-way and interactive.
- It encourages engagement and participation.
- It identifies and corrects misunderstandings quickly.

Q8. Write the qualities of a good speaker.

[4 marks]

Ans. A good speaker possesses the following qualities:

- **Clarity:** Speaks clearly and pronounces words correctly.
- **Confidence:** Delivers message with assurance and conviction.
- **Conciseness:** Avoids unnecessary words and stays to the point.
- **Empathy:** Understands the audience and adjusts the message accordingly.

- **Good Vocabulary:** Uses appropriate and varied words.
- **Proper Pace:** Speaks at a suitable speed — neither too fast nor too slow.
- **Positive Body Language:** Maintains eye contact, good posture, and appropriate gestures.

Q9. What is formal communication? Give examples.

[2 marks]

Ans. Formal communication is structured, official communication that follows prescribed rules and channels. It is used in professional and organisational settings.

Examples: Meetings, interviews, presentations, board discussions, official speeches.

Q10. What is informal communication? Give examples.

[2 marks]

Ans. Informal communication is casual, unstructured communication that occurs naturally in everyday life without following any specific rules or hierarchy.

Examples: Conversations between friends, gossip among colleagues, family chit-chat.

Q11. Explain the communication process with a diagram / flow.

[6 marks]

Ans. The communication process is a step-by-step method by which a message travels from the sender to the receiver and back.

Steps in the Communication Process:

1. **Ideation:** The sender forms an idea or thought.
2. **Encoding:** The idea is converted into words, symbols, or signals.
3. **Transmission:** The encoded message is sent through a selected channel (voice, phone, email).
4. **Reception:** The receiver receives the message through sensory organs.
5. **Decoding:** The receiver interprets and understands the message.
6. **Feedback:** The receiver sends a response back to the sender.

Noise can occur at any stage and disrupt the flow of communication. Effective communication requires minimising noise and ensuring clear encoding and decoding.

Q12. What is paralanguage? Give examples.

[2 marks]

Ans. Paralanguage refers to the vocal elements of communication other than the actual words spoken. It includes tone, pitch, volume, speed, pauses, and intonation.

Examples: Speaking loudly to show anger, slowing down to emphasise a point, a rising tone to ask a question.

Q13. Write tips for attending a job interview.

[6 marks]

Ans.

1. **Preparation:** Research the company, its products, and the job role before the interview.
2. **Appearance:** Dress professionally and neatly.
3. **Punctuality:** Arrive 10–15 minutes before the scheduled time.
4. **Body Language:** Enter with a smile, greet the interviewer, and maintain good posture.
5. **Listening:** Listen carefully to each question before answering.
6. **Speaking:** Answer clearly, confidently, and concisely. Avoid unnecessary filler words.
7. **Positive Attitude:** Be enthusiastic and professional throughout.
8. **Closing:** Thank the interviewer at the end and express interest in the role.

Q14. What is kinesics?

[2 marks]

Ans. Kinesics is the study of communication through body movements, including gestures, posture, facial expressions, and eye contact. It is a branch of non-verbal communication.

Example: Nodding to show agreement, shaking head to disagree, folded arms to show resistance.

Q15. Differentiate between verbal and non-verbal communication.

[4 marks]

Ans.

Verbal Communication	Non-Verbal Communication
Uses spoken or written words.	Uses body language, gestures, expressions.
Easily documented and recalled.	Difficult to document or record.
Can be formal or informal.	Mostly informal and instinctive.
Misunderstanding possible due to language.	Sometimes universal (smile means happiness).

Q16. What is public speaking? What are its key elements?

[4 marks]

Ans. Public speaking is the act of delivering a speech or presentation to a live audience with the purpose of informing, persuading, or entertaining.

Key Elements:

- **Preparation:** Research and organise content in advance.
- **Opening:** Grab attention with a strong introduction.
- **Content:** Clear, structured body with supporting examples.
- **Delivery:** Confident voice, good pace, eye contact.
- **Closing:** Summarise points and leave a lasting impression.

Q17. Explain proxemics with examples.

[2 marks]

Ans. Proxemics is the study of how humans use space and distance during communication. Edward Hall identified four zones:

- **Intimate Zone (0–45 cm):** For very close relationships.
- **Personal Zone (45 cm–1.2 m):** Friends and family.
- **Social Zone (1.2–3.6 m):** Professional colleagues.
- **Public Zone (3.6 m+):** Public speaking situations.

Q18. What is telephone etiquette? Why is it important?

[4 marks]

Ans. Telephone etiquette refers to the set of rules and manners to be followed while making or receiving phone calls in a professional setting.

Key Rules:

- Answer calls within three rings.
- Greet the caller with a polite salutation.
- Speak clearly, slowly, and pleasantly.
- Take messages accurately if needed.
- Do not put the caller on hold for too long.
- End the call politely with a thank you.

Importance: Good telephone etiquette creates a positive impression, maintains professional relationships, and ensures effective communication.

Q19. State the principles of effective oral communication.

[6 marks]

Ans.

1. **Clarity:** Use simple and clear language that the listener can understand easily.
2. **Completeness:** Ensure the message contains all necessary information.
3. **Conciseness:** Avoid unnecessary words; be brief and to the point.

4. **Correctness:** Use grammatically correct language with accurate facts.
5. **Courtesy:** Be polite, respectful, and considerate in tone.
6. **Consideration:** Understand and respect the listener's background and perspective.
7. **Consistency:** Maintain a uniform tone and message throughout communication.

These are called the "7 C's of Communication" and are essential for effective oral communication.

Q20. What is the difference between hearing and listening?

[2 marks]

Ans.

Hearing	Listening
Passive physical process.	Active mental process.
Just receiving sound waves.	Understanding and interpreting the message.
Involuntary — happens automatically.	Voluntary — requires effort and concentration.
No action needed.	Requires feedback and response.